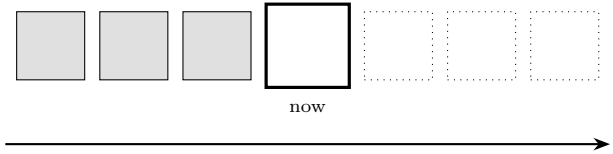
The ordinary picture

history → now → future



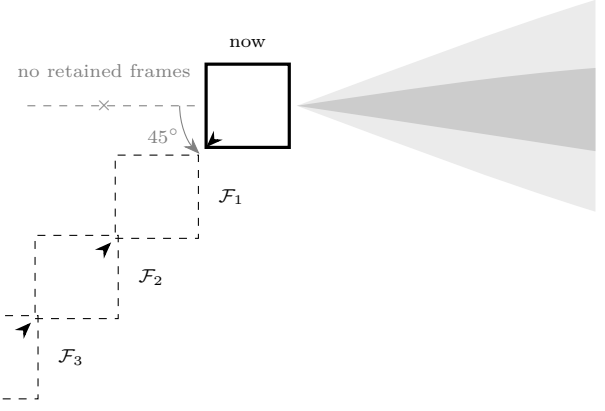
drawn as if still extant

drawn as if already there

This picture asserts two things without saying so:
that past states persist somewhere to the left, and
that the future is a region ahead waiting to be reached.
Neither is available to any frame.

The causal picture

succession, plus structural depth



superframes $\mathcal{F}_0 \subset \mathcal{F}_1 \subset \mathcal{F}_2 \subset \cdots$
containing structure, instantiated *now*,
possibly with no terminal frame

The tilt. Replacing time by structure entirely would be a 90° rotation, and is not the claim. Succession still runs: the ratchet through successive collapses is what makes a time dimension meaningful at all. What changes is where the *additional* determining structure is found — in containing frames, instantiated now, rather than in temporal states that no longer exist. Roughly a 45° change of causal vector, not a 90° replacement of time by structure.

THEORY FIGURE. The manifold is observer machinery — a representation a frame may construct, not a structure the world contains. The ratchet runs without it. Nothing in this diagram is instrumented in the reference substrate.